

Facilitating Learning

LEARNING – mental activity by means of which knowledge, skill, habits, attitudes and ideals are acquired, retained and utilized, resulting in the progressive adaptation and modification of conduct and behavior.

TYPES OF LEARNING

1. Sensory-motor	Understanding of the external world through sense perception. Development of movements as a reaction to stimuli.		
2. Cognitive Rational or mental or intellectual development	Association Learning Acquisition and retention of facts and information. Establishing relationships among ideas and experiences	Problem-solving Overcoming difficulties that appear to interfere with the attainment of goal.	
3. Affective (Appreciative) Involves acquisition of attitudes and interest as well as experience that will lift the individual above the tangible values associated with everyday life	Aesthetic Experiences Obtained in the field of music, art and literature	Intellectual Experiences Based on the premise that all learning has emotional correlates	Appreciative Experiences

THEORIES OF LEARNING

1. Stimulus – Response (Association) Theory States that for every stimulus there is a corresponding response	CONNECTIONISM – formulated by Edward Lee Thorndike - Assumes that human activities are based on the association or connection between stimulus and response. - It is the belief that all mental processes consist of the functioning of native and acquired connections between the situations and response		
	Fundamental Laws of Learning		
	Law of Readiness	Law of Exercise	Law of Effect
	When an individual is prepared to respond, or act, allowing him to do so is satisfying, whereas preventing him would be annoying.	Constant repetition of a response strengthens its connection with the stimulus, while disuse of a response weakens it.	Learning is strengthened if it results in satisfaction, but it is weakened if it leads to vexation or annoyance.
2. Theory of Conditioning The process of learning consists of the acquisition of new ways of reacting to stimuli developed through attaching new stimuli to established modes of behavior	Classical Conditioning		
	Based on the experiment on the reaction of the dog conducted by Ivan Pavlov, who postulated that conditioning consists of eliciting a response by means of a previously neutral or inadequate stimulus		
	Principles:		
	Adhesive Principle A response is attached to every stimulus. For every stimulus, there is always a corresponding response	Excitation Also known as the law of acquisition. It occurs when a previously neutral stimulus gains the ability of eliciting the response	Extinction Also known as unlearning and occurs when the conditioned response is no longer elicited by the conditioned stimulus because the conditioned stimulus is frequently presented without the paired stimulus
	Stimulus Generalization Happens when the conditional response is also elicited by other stimuli similar to		Spontaneous recovery Happens when a conditioned response which does not appear for sometime



	the conditioned stimulus	but reoccurs without the need of further conditioning.
	Operant Conditioning	
	A theory based on the experiment conducted by Burrhus Frederick Skinner on a hungry rat. He believed that since an organism tends in the future to do what it was doing at the time of reinforcement, one can train that organism either by presenting him a reward or punishment as a consequence of his actions.	
	Feedback Principle: states that an organism's responses maybe reinforced by presentation or removal, or simply put, rewards and punishments.	
3. Social Learning Theory	The first model was rewarded, the second was punished while nothing was done to the third model. Children were then asked to choose among these models. The children chose the first model, then the no consequence model and the last choice was the model who was punished. Based on this experiment, it was viewed that children's learning process involves observation and imitation.	
Based on the studies of Richard Wallace and Albert Bandura concerning a group of children who were exposed to three models in films.		
	This theory defines learning as a relativistic process by which a learner develops new insights and changes the old ones	
	Types of Cognitive Field Theory	
	a. Insight Learning: a basic sense of, or feeling for relationships. Used to denote the meaning of a matter, idea or point. The insights of a person are not equated with his consciousness or awareness of his ability to describe them verbally; their essence is a sense of, or feeling for pattern in a life situation. This theory is based on experiment conducted by Wolfgang Kohler, who postulated that the more intelligent the organism and the more experiences he has the more capable he if of gaining higher insight.	
4. Cognitive Field Theory	b. Vector and Topological Theory: derived from the terms vector which means a quantity that has magnitude and direction and topology which is concerned with properties of geometric configuration which are unaltered by elastic deformations. Kurt Lewin states that individuals exist on a field of forces within his environment that move, change and give him a degree of stability and substance or define his behavior. The behavior of an individual is a result of forces operating simultaneously within his environment and life space.	
Otherwise known as Field Theory describes how a person gains understanding of himself and his world in a situation where his self and his environment compose a totality of mutually independent, coexisting events.	c. Gestalt Learning: It claims that the whole is more than the sum of its parts and the whole gets its meaning from its parts. Gestalt view learning as a change in knowledge, skills, attitudes, values or beliefs and may or may not have anything to do with the change in overt behavior. It further claims that one does not learn by doing; for learning to occur, doing must be accompanied by realization of consequences. Thus, learning occurs as a result of or through experiences. Learning, therefore, involves the catching, and generalization of insights which often are acquired first on a nonverbal level or the level of feeling any may be verbalized later or may not be verbalized at all.	
	d. Instrumental Conceptualism: applied to the theory advocated by Jerome Bruner, who believed that the acquisition of whatever form of knowledge is always a dynamic and interactive process because the learner purposively participates in the process of knowledge acquisition who selects, structures, retains and transforms information. Bruner argued that learning is thinking and thinking is the process whereby one makes sense out of the various and somehow unrelated facts through a process called conceptualization or categorization.	
	CONDITIONS OF LEARNING	
	Gagne Assumption: Assumption is that different types of learning exist and that different instructional conditions are most likely to bring about these different types of learning.	
Five Major Categories of	Hierarchy according to complexity of Intellectual Skills	

**Learning:**

1. Verbal information
2. Intellectual skills
3. Cognitive strategies
4. Motor skills
5. Attitudes

Stimulus recognition → Response generation → Procedure following → Use terminology → Discriminations → Concept formation → Rule application → Problem solving

**The primary significance of the hierarchy is to identify prerequisites that should be completed to facilitate learning at each level. Prerequisites are identified by doing a task analysis of a learning/training task. Learning hierarchies provide a basis for the sequencing of instruction.

Nine Instructional Events:

1. Gaining attention (reception)
2. Informing learners of the objective (expectancy)
3. Stimulating recall of prior learning (retrieval)
4. Presenting the stimulus (selective perception)
5. Providing learning guidance (semantic encoding)
6. Eliciting performance (responding)
7. Providing feedback (reinforcement)
8. Assessing performance (retrieval)
9. Enhancing retention and transfer (generalization)